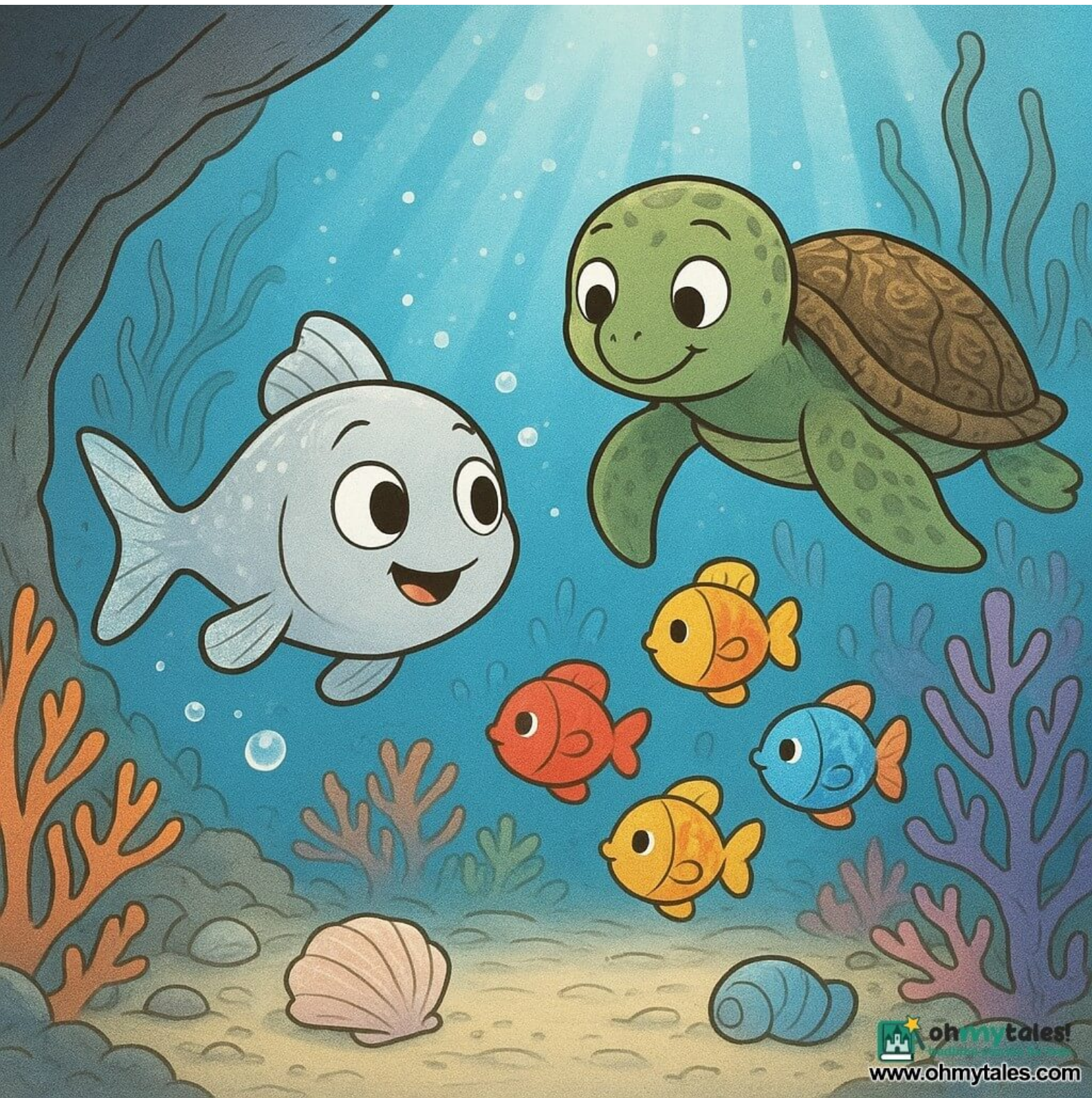


Finley and the Shimmering Sea Adventure

Underwater travel story • 3-4 years old



Part 1: The Shimmering Sea

Once upon a time, in a bright and colorful ocean, lived a tiny, friendly fish named Finley. Finley was small and silver, with a tail that sparkled like sunshine. Every day, Finley loved to swim around, playing with bubbles and making new friends.

One sunny morning, Finley met a wise old turtle named Tilly. « **Hello, Finley!** » Tilly said with a smile. « **I heard there's a magical place deep under the sea. It's full of glowing coral and shimmering shells.** »

« **Oh, that sounds amazing, Tilly!** » Finley said, his eyes wide with wonder. « **Can we go there?** »

« **Of course, little one,** » Tilly replied kindly. « **But remember, the ocean can be tricky. Stay close to me, and we'll have a great adventure.** »

Finley nodded, feeling excited and a little brave. Together, they swam through the gentle waves, past tall seaweed forests that swayed softly. Everywhere they went, fish of all colors danced around them, as if saying hello.

Part 2: The Narrow Passage

As they swam deeper into the ocean, the water around them started to glow. « **Look, Finley!** » Tilly said happily. « **The magical place is near!** »

Finley wiggled his little tail in delight. « **I can't wait to see it, Tilly!** »

Soon, they reached a narrow passage. It was a bit dark, with rocks on both sides, but Tilly's calm voice made Finley feel safe. « **We must be careful here,** » Tilly said. « **But don't worry, Finley. We'll get through together.** »

Finley took a deep breath. « **Okay, Tilly. I'll be brave!** »

As they swam through the passage, Finley could feel his heart beating fast. But he remembered Tilly's wise words and stayed close by. With each wiggle and swish, they moved together as a team.

« **You're doing great, Finley,** » Tilly encouraged. And with one last swish, they were out of the passage and into the most beautiful place Finley had ever seen.

Part 3: The Glowing Garden

Before Finley, the ocean floor was covered in glowing coral, shining all around like little stars. There were shimmering shells, and gentle, colorful fish swimming happily.

« **Wow!** » Finley gasped. « **This is wonderful, Tilly! Thank you for bringing me here.** »

Tilly chuckled softly. « **I'm glad you like it, Finley. And look, our friends have come to celebrate!** »

All around them, sea creatures gathered, playing and sharing the wonders of the glowing garden. Finley felt so happy. He loved sharing this magical place with everyone.

As the adventure came to an end, Finley and Tilly swam back through the passage, this time filled with joy and courage. They knew they had discovered something special, and Finley felt braver and brighter than ever.

When they returned home, Finley thanked Tilly. « **Thank you for the adventure, Tilly. I had so much fun!** »

Tilly smiled warmly. « **You're welcome, Finley. Remember, the ocean is full of**

wonders, and you are always brave enough to explore. »

And with that, Finley waved goodbye to Tilly and headed home, dreaming of future adventures under the shimmering sea.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) Who is the little fish in the story?

- Finley
- Tilly
- Nemo
- Bubbles

2) Who is the wise old friend that swims with Finley?

- Tilly the turtle
- Sam the shark
- Penny the penguin
- Lola the lobster

3) What special place do they visit?

- The glowing garden
- The sandy beach
- A deep cave
- The shipwreck

4) How does Finley feel after the adventure?

- Brave and happy
- Sleepy and cold
- Scared and alone
- Angry and bored

Correct answers:

1) Finley 2) Tilly the turtle 3) The glowing garden 4) Brave and happy

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Sparkled: Shined with many tiny points of light like little stars

Magical place: A special spot that feels full of wonder and surprises

Glowing coral: Rock-like sea plants that give off a soft light under water

Shimmering shells: Sea shells that shine and seem to move with the light

Seaweed forests: Tall groups of sea plants that sway like trees in water

Narrow passage: A small, tight way to swim through between rocks

Ocean floor: The bottom of the sea where sand and rocks lie

Glowing garden: A bright, light-filled part of the sea with pretty plants

Shimmering sea: The ocean that looks like it is shining and sparkling